

Word family: **soft / softer / softest / softly / softness / soften / softening**

Base word: soft

Comparative: softer

Superlative: softest

Adverb: softly

Noun: softness

Verb: soften

Useful constructions/extensions: soft skin, soft chair, soft voice, soft music, soft light, soft colour, soft weather, soft heart, soft approach, soft punishment, soft target, soft drink, soft water, soft copy, soft skills, software

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / related adverb, noun, and verb forms (相關副詞、名詞及動詞)

1. **soft = not hard to touch (柔軟的) — 柔軟 ; 軟的**

This is the basic literal meaning.

Meaning: Easy to press, bend, cut, or change shape; not hard or rigid.

Practice 1

> “The pillow is very **soft**.”

「這個枕頭很**柔軟**。」

Practice 2

> “She has **soft skin**.”

「她的皮膚很**柔嫩**。」

soft = 觸感不硬、不僵，容易被壓下或改變形狀

2. **soft material/fabric (柔軟材質) — 柔軟的**

Practice 3

> “The blanket is made from a **soft fabric**.”

「這張毛毯由**柔軟的布料**製成。」

Practice 4

> “Choose a soft towel for the baby.”

「替寶寶選一條**柔軟的毛巾**。」

soft = 材料摸起來柔和、不粗硬

3. **soft food (軟身食物) — 軟的 ; 容易咀嚼**

A common physical extension.

Practice 5

> “Cook the vegetables until they are **soft**.”

「把蔬菜煮到**變軟**。」

Practice 6

> “The bread is still soft.”

「麵包仍然很**鬆軟**。」

soft food = 質地不硬、容易咬 / 咀嚼

4. **soft ground/surface (土地鬆軟) — 軟 ; 不堅實**

Practice 7

> “The ground was **soft** after the rain.”

「下雨後地面變得很**鬆軟**。」

Practice 8

> “Be careful—the surface is soft.”

「小心，這個表面很**軟 / 不堅實**。」

soft = 地面 / 表面缺乏硬度或穩固性

5. **soft = comfortable and yielding (柔軟舒適的) — 柔軟舒服**

Practice 9

> “She sat in a **soft chair**.”

「她坐在一張**柔軟舒服的椅子**上。」

Practice 10

> “The bed is too soft for me.”

「這張床對我來說太**軟**了。」

soft = 因能稍微下陷 / 承托身體而感覺舒服

6. **soft = quiet / low in volume (輕柔的) — 輕聲；柔和**

A major sensory sense.

Practice 11

> “She spoke in a **soft voice**.”

「她用**輕柔的聲音**說話。」

Practice 12

> “Soft music was playing in the background.”

「背景播放著**輕柔的音樂**。」

soft sound/voice = 音量較低、聽起來柔和而不刺耳

7. **soft voice (柔聲) — 溫柔 / 輕柔的聲音**

Practice 13

> “Her **soft voice** made everyone feel calm.”

「她**溫柔的聲音**令大家感到平靜。」

Practice 14

> “He answered in a soft voice.”

「他用**輕聲**回答。」

****soft voice = 音量不大，而且通常帶溫和、舒服的聽感****

8. ****softly (輕聲地 / 柔和地) — 輕輕地 ; 柔和地****

A major related adverb.

Practice 15

> “She spoke ****softly****.”

「她**輕聲地**說話。」

Practice 16

> “The music played softly in the room.”

「音樂在房間裡**輕柔地**播放。」

****softly = 以低聲、柔和、不強烈的方式****

9. ****soft = gentle in light (柔和的光) — 柔和 ; 不刺眼****

A major visual sense.

Practice 17

> “The room was filled with ****soft light****.”

「房間裡充滿了**柔和的光線**。」

Practice 18

> “Soft lighting creates a relaxing atmosphere.”

「**柔和燈光**能營造放鬆氣氛。」

soft light = 光線不強烈、不刺眼，過渡柔和

10. **soft colour** (柔和顏色) — 淡雅；柔和

Practice 19

> “She prefers **soft colours**.”

「她較喜歡**柔和的顏色**。」

Practice 20

> “The room was decorated in soft blue and grey.”

「房間以**柔和的藍色和灰色**裝飾。」

soft colour = 顏色不鮮烈、不刺眼，視覺感較溫和

11. **soft** = gentle / mild in appearance (柔和的) — 柔和；溫柔

Practice 21

> “The painting has **soft lines**.”

「這幅畫的線條很**柔和**。」

Practice 22

> “Her face had soft features.”

「她的五官線條很**柔和**。」

soft = 視覺輪廓沒有強烈、尖銳或硬朗感

12. **soft** = gentle in manner/personality (溫柔的) — 溫和；柔和

A major figurative sense.

Practice 23

> “She has a **soft manner**.”

「她待人很**溫和**。」

Practice 24

> “He is soft-spoken and patient.”

「他說話**溫和**，而且很有耐性。」

soft = 性格 / 態度不強硬、不粗暴，而是溫和柔善

13. **soft-spoken (說話溫柔的) — 語氣溫和；輕聲細語**

A common compound.

Practice 25

> “She is a **soft-spoken** teacher.”

「她是一位**說話溫柔的老師**。」

Practice 26

> “His soft-spoken manner made people feel comfortable.”

「他**溫和的說話方式**令大家很自在。」

soft-spoken = 說話聲音較輕、語氣平和而不強勢

14. **soft-hearted (心軟的；有同情心的) — 心地柔軟；容易同情**

A major compound.

Practice 27

> “She is very **soft-hearted**.”

「她很**心軟 / 富有同情心**。」

Practice 28

> “He looks strict, but he is actually soft-hearted.”

「他看起來很嚴格，但其實很**心軟**。」

soft-hearted = 很容易同情別人、對別人的困難心軟

15. **soft spot for someone/something (特別喜愛) — 特別疼愛；有偏愛**

A major idiom.

Practice 29

> “She has a **soft spot for** children.”

「她對孩子**特別疼愛**。」

Practice 30

> “I’ve always had a soft spot for old cafés.”

「我一直對老咖啡店**特別有好感**。」

have a soft spot for X = 對某人 / 某物有特別溫柔、喜愛或偏愛的感情

16. **soft = not strict / not severe (不嚴厲的) — 寬鬆；不強硬**

A major figurative sense.

Practice 31

> “The teacher is too **soft** on late students.”

「老師對遲到的學生太**寬鬆**。」

Practice 32

> “Some people thought the punishment was too soft.”

「有些人認為處罰太**輕 / 不夠嚴厲**。」

****soft = 對規則、錯誤、處罰等不夠嚴格或強硬****

17. ****soft on someone (對某人太寬鬆) — 心軟 ; 不夠嚴格****

Practice 33

> “Don’t be too ****soft on him****.”

「不要對他太****心軟 / 太寬鬆****。」

Practice 34

> “The manager is soft on inexperienced staff.”

「經理對經驗不足的員工比較****寬容****。」

****be soft on someone = 對某人較寬容、不願嚴格要求或處罰****

18. ****soft approach (溫和手段) — 溫和方式 ; 柔性策略****

A common figurative extension.

Practice 35

> “They took a ****soft approach**** to the problem.”

「他們採取了較****溫和的處理方式****。」

Practice 36

> “A softer approach may work better.”

「較****柔和的方式****可能更有效。」

****soft approach = 不以強硬、懲罰或對抗為主，而採取勸導、合作等方式****

19. ****soft = weak / lacking toughness (軟弱的) — 軟弱 ; 不夠堅強****

A potentially negative sense.

Practice 37

> “He worried that people would think he was **soft**.”

「他擔心別人會覺得他很**軟弱**。」

Practice 38

> “The coach accused the team of being too soft.”

「教練批評球隊太**缺乏韌性 / 不夠強硬**。」

soft = 缺乏堅韌、強硬、競爭性或承受壓力的能力

Informal and often evaluative.

20. **soft = easy / not demanding (容易的) — 輕鬆 ; 要求低**

A useful informal sense.

Practice 39

> “They gave him a **soft assignment**.”

「他們給了他一項**較輕鬆的任務**。」

Practice 40

> “The course is not a soft option.”

「這門課並不是一個**容易混過去的選擇**。」

soft = 難度 / 要求較低 , 不需要太多努力

21. **soft option (容易的選擇) — 輕鬆選項 ; 避難就易**

A common British-English expression.

Practice 41

> “Taking the easier route may look like the **soft option**.”

「選擇較容易的方法可能看起來像是在**避難就易**。」

Practice 42

> “This is not a soft option.”

「這並不是一個**輕鬆的選擇**。」

****soft option = 被認為較容易、不需面對太多困難的選項****

Often slightly critical.

22. ****soft target (容易攻擊 / 批評的目標) — 容易下手的目標****

A major figurative compound.

Practice 43

> “Small companies can become ****soft targets**** for fraud.”

「小公司可能成為詐騙者****容易下手的目標****。」

Practice 44

> “He became a soft target for criticism.”

「他成為了****很容易被批評的對象****。」

****soft target = 因防備弱、地位弱或容易利用而特別容易被攻擊 / 批評的人或事物****

23. ****soft = mild weather/climate (溫和的天氣) — 溫和；不寒冷****

A less central but established sense.

Practice 45

> “The region has a ****soft climate****.”

「該地區氣候較****溫和****。」

Practice 46

> “A soft rain fell all afternoon.”

「整個下午都下著**細柔的雨**。」

soft = 天氣、雨等不強烈、較溫和

This is less common than some other senses but still established.

24. **soft rain (細雨 / 柔和的雨) — 細柔的雨**

Practice 47

> “A **soft rain** began to fall.”

「開始下起了**柔和細雨**。」

Practice 48

> “The soft rain made the garden quiet.”

「**細雨**令花園顯得很安靜。」

soft rain = 雨勢輕、不猛烈

25. **soft = low intensity / gentle impact (力度輕) — 輕柔；不猛烈**

Practice 49

> “She gave the door a **soft push**.”

「她**輕輕推了**門一下。」

Practice 50

> “The ball landed with a soft bounce.”

「球**輕輕地彈了一下**。」

soft = 力度小、衝擊不強

26. **soft landing (軟著陸 / 平穩著陸) — 平穩落地**

A major literal and figurative compound.

Practice 51

> “The aircraft made a **soft landing**.”

「飛機**平穩著陸**。」

Practice 52

> “The company hopes for a soft landing after rapid growth.”

「公司希望高速增長後能夠**平穩過渡**。」

soft landing = 字面指平穩、低衝擊的著陸；比喻上指避免嚴重衰退 / 衝擊的平穩調整

27. **soft = not sharply defined (模糊柔化的) — 柔焦；邊緣不清晰**

A visual/photography sense.

Practice 53

> “The photograph has a **soft focus**.”

「這張照片用了**柔焦效果**。」

Practice 54

> “The background appears soft and blurred.”

「背景看起來**柔化而模糊**。」

soft = 邊緣、細節或焦點不尖銳清楚，而呈柔化效果

28. **soft focus (柔焦) — 柔焦效果**

Practice 55

> “The portrait was shot in **soft focus**.”

「這張人像用了**柔焦**拍攝。」

Practice 56

> “Soft focus gives the image a gentle look.”

「**柔焦效果**令照片看起來更柔和。」

****soft focus = 有意降低影像邊緣清晰度以產生柔和效果****

29. ****soft = less strong / less direct statement (委婉的) — 委婉；不強烈****

A discourse/business extension.

Practice 57

> “He gave a ****soft warning**** rather than a direct threat.”

「他作出了較****委婉的警告****，而不是直接威脅。」

Practice 58

> “The criticism was softened before publication.”

「批評內容在發布前被****弱化 / 緩和****了。」

****soft = 語言、立場或訊息不尖銳、不強硬****

30. ****soft sell (軟性推銷) — 溫和推銷；軟銷****

A major marketing expression.

Practice 59

> “The advertisement uses a ****soft-sell approach****.”

「這則廣告採取****軟性推銷****方式。」

Practice 60

> “The company prefers soft sell to aggressive advertising.”

「公司較喜歡**軟性推銷**，而不是強勢廣告。」

soft sell = 不直接施壓，而透過較溫和、間接方式說服顧客

31. **soft power (軟實力) — 軟實力**

A major international-relations/social-science compound.

Practice 61

> “Culture can be a source of **soft power**.”

「文化可以成為一種**軟實力**。」

Practice 62

> “The country invested in cultural soft power.”

「該國投資於文化**軟實力**。」

soft power = 透過文化、價值觀、吸引力、外交等非強迫方式影響別人的能力

This is an established specialist-but-general compound.

32. **soft skills (軟技能) — 人際 / 溝通軟技能**

A very common workplace compound.

Practice 63

> “Communication is an important **soft skill**.”

「溝通是一項重要的**軟技能**。」

Practice 64

> “Employers value both technical and soft skills.”

「僱主同時重視技術能力和**軟技能**。」

soft skills = 溝通、合作、適應、領導等非技術性的人際 / 行為能力

33. ****soft data (軟資料 / 主觀資料) — 非量化資料****

A useful analytical contrast.

Practice 65

> “Interviews provide ****soft data**** about customer attitudes.”

「訪談提供了關於顧客態度的****非量化 / 主觀資料****。」

Practice 66

> “Soft data can complement numerical evidence.”

「****質性 / 非量化資料****可以補充數字證據。」

****soft data = 較難精確量化、可能包含主觀判斷的資料****

Secondary but useful in business/research.

34. ****soft = not legally binding / less formal (非強制性的) — 非硬性；彈性****

A useful institutional sense.

Practice 67

> “The deadline is relatively ****soft****.”

「這個期限比較****有彈性 / 不是硬性規定****。」

Practice 68

> “These are soft guidelines rather than strict rules.”

「這些是較****彈性的指引****，而不是嚴格規則。」

****soft = 不完全固定、強制或嚴格執行****

35. ****soft drink (汽水 / 非酒精飲品) — 軟飲；非酒精飲品****

A major lexicalized compound.

Practice 69

> “Would you like a **soft drink**?”

「你想要一杯**汽水 / 非酒精飲品**嗎？」

Practice 70

> “The restaurant serves beer and soft drinks.”

「餐廳供應啤酒和**非酒精飲品**。」

soft drink = 非酒精飲品，尤其汽水類

Here **soft** does not mean physically soft.

36. **soft water (軟水) — 軟水**

A major technical/everyday compound.

Practice 71

> “This area has **soft water**.”

「這個地區的水屬於**軟水**。」

Practice 72

> “Soap lathers easily in soft water.”

「肥皂在**軟水**中很容易起泡。」

soft water = 鈣、鎂等礦物離子含量較低的水

This contrasts with:

> hard water.

37. **soft copy (電子版本) — 電子檔；非紙本版本**

A useful modern compound, especially in South Asian/international business English.

Practice 73

> “Please send me a **soft copy** of the document.”

「請把文件的**電子版本**寄給我。」

Practice 74

> “I have the soft copy but not the printed version.”

「我有**電子檔**，但沒有打印版本。」

soft copy = 電子 / 數碼形式的文件，與 hard copy 相對

Regional note: **digital copy/electronic copy** is often more universally natural.

38. **soft currency** (弱勢 / 不穩定貨幣) — 軟貨幣

A financial term.

Practice 75

> “The country’s currency was considered a **soft currency**.”

「該國貨幣被視為**弱勢 / 不穩定貨幣**。」

Practice 76

> “Soft currencies may be difficult to exchange internationally.”

「**軟貨幣**在國際上可能較難兌換。」

soft currency = 價值不穩定、國際需求較低或可兌換性較弱的貨幣

Specialist but established.

39. **soft market** (疲弱市場) — 市況疲弱；買方市場

A business/economic sense.

Practice 77

> “Property prices fell in a **soft market**.”

「在**市況疲弱的市場**中，樓價下跌。」

Practice 78

> “Demand remains soft.”

「需求仍然**疲弱**。」

soft market/demand = 需求、價格或商業活動較弱，不活躍

40. **soft** = weak in demand/economy (疲弱的) — 疲弱；走軟

Practice 79

> “Sales were **soft** in the second quarter.”

「第二季銷售表現**疲弱**。」

Practice 80

> “Demand has softened.”

「需求已經**轉弱**。」

soft = 商業 / 經濟活動、價格、需求等不強勁

41. **soften** = become/make physically soft (變軟) — 軟化；變軟

A major related verb.

Practice 81

> “Heat will **soften** the butter.”

「熱力會令牛油**變軟**。」

Practice 82

> “Let the fruit soften before eating it.”

「讓水果**變軟**後再吃。」

soften = 令某物硬度降低，或本身變得較軟

42. **soften = become less severe/harsh (緩和) — 軟化；緩和**

A major figurative verb sense.

Practice 83

> “Her expression **softened**.”

「她的表情**柔和下來**。」

Practice 84

> “He softened his criticism.”

「他把批評的語氣**緩和了**。」

soften = 令態度、語氣、表情、規則等變得較不嚴厲 / 尖銳

43. **soften your tone/position (緩和語氣 / 立場) — 放軟；緩和**

Practice 85

> “She **softened her tone**.”

「她**放柔了語氣**。」

Practice 86

> “The company later softened its position.”

「公司後來**軟化了立場**。」

soften = 從較強硬狀態轉為較溫和 / 有彈性

44. **softness = physical softness (柔軟) — 柔軟度**

A major related noun.

Practice 87

> “I like the **softness** of this blanket.”

「我喜歡這張毛毯的**柔軟觸感**。」

Practice 88

> “The fabric is known for its softness.”

「這種布料以**柔軟**聞名。」

softness = 不硬、觸感柔和的性質

45. **softness = gentleness (溫柔) — 柔和；溫柔**

Practice 89

> “There was a **softness in her voice**.”

「她的聲音中帶著一種**溫柔**。」

Practice 90

> “The softness of her manner put people at ease.”

「她態度中的**溫和**令人放鬆。」

softness = 聲音、態度、表情等溫和、不強硬的特質

46. **software (軟件) — 軟體；軟件**

A highly important lexicalized family member.

Practice 91

> “The company develops **software**.”

「這家公司開發**軟件 / 軟體**。」

Practice 92

> “You need to update the software.”

「你需要更新**軟件**。」

****software = 電腦、電話等裝置上運行的程式和數碼指令系統****

This contrasts with:

> hardware.

It is a lexicalized compound and should not be treated as a normal adjective use of ****soft****.

47. ****soft launch (軟啟動 / 小規模試推出) — 試運行 ; 低調推出****

A major modern business/product compound.

Practice 93

> “The app had a ****soft launch**** before the full release.”

「這款應用程式在正式推出前先進行了****小規模試推出****。」

Practice 94

> “They soft-launched the service in one city.”

「他們先在一個城市****低調試推出****這項服務。」

****soft launch = 在正式大規模發布前，以有限規模 / 低調方式推出作測試****

****Important distinction: **soft vs smooth****

These are often confused.

**soft**

= not hard; easy to press.

smooth

= surface is even, without roughness.

A stone can be:

> smooth but hard.

A sponge can be:

> soft but not perfectly smooth.

Different physical properties.

Important distinction: **soft vs gentle**

soft

can describe:

- * texture;
- * sound;
- * light;
- * attitude.

gentle

focuses more strongly on:

- * mild force;
- * kind behaviour;
- * calm manner.

> soft voice

and:

> gentle voice

overlap, but **soft** emphasizes sound quality while **gentle** emphasizes manner.

Important distinction: **soft vs quiet**

soft voice

= low and gentle in volume/tone.

quiet voice

= not loud.

Soft often adds warmth/gentleness beyond simple volume.

Important distinction: **soft vs low — sound**

soft music

= quiet/gentle music.

low voice

can mean low volume or low pitch depending context.

deep voice

= low pitch.

So:

> soft ≠ deep.

A voice can be:

> deep but loud

or:

> high-pitched but soft.

Important distinction: **soft vs weak**

soft

can sometimes mean weak/not tough.

But in many contexts:

> soft

is positive:

* soft blanket;

* soft voice;

* soft light.

weak

usually means lacking strength/power.

Do not translate every **soft** as:

> 弱.

Important distinction: **soft-hearted vs weak**

soft-hearted

= compassionate/easily moved emotionally.

weak

= lacking strength, determination, or power.

A soft-hearted person can still be very strong-minded.

Important distinction: **soft vs kind**

kind

= caring and considerate.

soft

when describing personality may mean:

- * gentle;
- * not strict;
- * emotionally tender.

Someone can be kind but firm.

Someone described as too soft may be kind ****and insufficiently strict****.

Important distinction: **soft on someone vs kind to someone**

**kind to someone**

= treat them with care.

**soft on someone**

= not strict enough with them.

> “She is kind to her students.”

positive.

> “She is too soft on her students.”

suggests excessive leniency.

Important distinction: **soft approach vs weak approach**

**soft approach**

= deliberately gentle/non-confrontational strategy.

**weak approach**

= ineffective/lacking strength.

A soft approach can be highly effective.

So ****soft**** does not automatically mean poor.

Important distinction: ****soft light vs dim light****

****soft light****

= gentle, diffused, not harsh.

****dim light****

= low brightness.

Light can be bright but soft if well diffused.

Important distinction: ****soft colour vs pale colour****

****soft colour****

= visually gentle/not harsh.

****pale colour****

= light in value, containing less intensity/darkness.

They often overlap but are not identical.

Important distinction: ****soft food vs tender food****

****soft****

= texture is easy to press/chew.

****tender****

especially meat/vegetables:

= easy to cut or chew, usually desirable.

A banana can be soft; “tender banana” would be unusual.

Important distinction: ****soft water vs hard water****

This is a technical contrast.

soft water

= low concentration of calcium/magnesium ions.

hard water

= higher concentration of these minerals.

It has nothing to do with physical softness.

Important distinction: **soft drink vs soft water**

soft drink

= non-alcoholic beverage, especially carbonated drink.

soft water

= low-mineral water.

Same adjective, completely different compounds.

Important distinction: **soft drink vs alcoholic drink**

Historically/conventionally, **soft drink** contrasts with:

> alcoholic drink.

It does not mean:

> a drink with a soft texture.

Important distinction: **soft copy vs hard copy**

soft copy

= electronic/digital version.

hard copy

= printed/tangible version.

For broad international English, **digital copy** and **electronic copy** may be more universally transparent than **soft copy**.

Important distinction: **soft skills vs hard skills**

soft skills

= interpersonal/behavioural abilities:

- * communication;
- * teamwork;
- * adaptability;
- * leadership.

hard skills

= technical/job-specific abilities:

- * coding;
- * accounting;
- * machine operation.

This is an established workplace contrast.

Important distinction: **soft power vs hard power**

soft power

= influence through attraction, culture, values, diplomacy.

hard power

= influence through military or economic coercion.

The contrast is metaphorical:

> attraction vs force.

Important distinction: ****soft target vs easy task****

****soft target****

= someone/something vulnerable to attack, exploitation, or criticism.

****easy task****

= something simple to complete.

Do not interpret:

> soft target

as merely:

> an easy assignment.

Important distinction: ****soft landing literal vs figurative****

Literal:

> gentle aircraft/spacecraft landing.

Figurative:

> gradual adjustment without severe damage or collapse.

The figurative use is common in economics/business.

Important distinction: ****soft market vs cheap market****

****soft market****

= demand/activity/prices are weak.

****cheap market****

is not a standard equivalent.

****Soft**** describes market conditions, not simply low prices.

Important distinction: **soften vs weaken**

**soften**

= make less hard, harsh, severe, or confrontational.

**weaken**

= reduce strength/effectiveness/power.

> soften your tone

does not mean:

> make your argument ineffective.

It means:

> make the delivery gentler.

Important distinction: **softness vs weakness**

**softness**

can mean:

* physical tenderness;

* gentleness;

* warmth.

**weakness**

= lack of strength/effectiveness.

They overlap only in some evaluative contexts.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **soft** family is exceptionally rich across physical, sensory, interpersonal, technical, and business meanings:

- * **soft — texture** = 柔軟的
- * **soft food** = 軟身食物
- * **soft chair/bed** = 柔軟舒適
- * **soft voice/music** = 輕柔的聲音 / 音樂
- * **softly** = 輕聲 / 柔和地
- * **soft light** = 柔和光線
- * **soft colour** = 柔和顏色
- * **soft features** = 柔和輪廓
- * **soft — personality/manner** = 溫和
- * **soft-spoken** = 說話溫柔的
- * **soft-hearted** = 心軟 / 有同情心
- * **soft spot for** = 特別喜愛 / 疼愛
- * **soft on someone** = 對某人過於寬鬆
- * **soft approach** = 溫和策略
- * **soft — weak/not tough** = 不夠強硬
- * **soft option** = 容易的選項
- * **soft target** = 容易被攻擊 / 利用的目標
- * **soft weather/rain** = 溫和天氣 / 細雨
- * **soft push/impact** = 力度輕
- * **soft landing** = 平穩著陸 / 平穩過渡
- * **soft focus** = 柔焦
- * **soft warning/message** = 委婉、不強硬的訊息
- * **soft sell** = 軟性推銷
- * **soft power** = 軟實力
- * **soft skills** = 軟技能
- * **soft data** = 非量化 / 主觀資料
- * **soft deadline/rule** = 非硬性 / 有彈性的
- * **soft drink** = 非酒精飲品 / 汽水
- * **soft water** = 軟水
- * **soft copy** = 電子版本
- * **soft currency** = 弱勢 / 不穩定貨幣
- * **soft market/demand** = 市況 / 需求疲弱
- * **soften — physical** = 變軟
- * **soften — figurative** = 緩和 / 放軟
- * **softness — physical** = 柔軟度
- * **softness — manner** = 溫柔 / 柔和
- * **software** = 軟件 / 軟體
- * **soft launch** = 小規模 / 低調試推出

The main semantic branches are:

> **not physically hard**

> **quiet or gentle to the senses**

> **gentle in personality or treatment**

> **not strict / not forceful**

> **weak / easy / vulnerable**

> **lower intensity or demand**

plus many important lexicalized compounds in:

> **technology, business, economics, water, drinks, and workplace language**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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soft — texture	觸感不硬、不僵，容易被壓下 / 改變形狀
soft food	質地不硬，容易咀嚼 / 切開
soft voice/music	音量較低、聽感柔和而不刺耳
softly	以輕聲、柔和、不強烈的方式
soft light	光線不強烈、不刺眼，視覺過渡柔和
soft colour	顏色不鮮烈、不刺眼，視覺感溫和
soft — manner	態度、性格不強硬、粗暴，而較溫和
soft-spoken	說話聲音較輕、語氣溫和而不強勢
soft-hearted	容易同情別人、心地柔軟的
soft spot for	對某人 / 某物有特別喜愛、疼愛或偏愛
soft on someone	對某人不夠嚴格、較心軟
soft approach	採取非強硬、非對抗、較溫和的處理方式
soft — weak/toughness	缺乏堅韌、強硬或競爭性
soft option	較容易、不需承受很多困難的選擇
soft target	因防備 / 地位較弱而容易被攻擊、利用或批評的對象
soft landing	低衝擊平穩著陸；比喻指避免嚴重後果的平穩調整
soft focus	降低影像邊緣清晰度而形成的柔和效果
soft sell	不直接施壓、以溫和間接方式進行推銷
soft power	透過文化、價值、吸引力等非強制方式產生影響力
soft skills	溝通、合作、適應等非技術性人際 / 行為能力
soft deadline/rule	並非完全固定或強制執行、具有彈性的要求
soft drink	非酒精飲品，尤其汽水類
soft water	鈣、鎂等礦物離子含量較低的水
soft copy	文件的電子 / 數碼版本
soft market/demand	需求、價格或商業活動較疲弱
soften — physical	令硬度降低，或本身變得較軟

soften — figurative	令態度、語氣、規則或立場變得較溫和	
softness	柔軟；亦可指聲音、態度中的溫柔柔和	
software	電腦 / 電子裝置上運行的程式及數碼指令系統	
soft launch	正式全面推出前的小規模、低調測試性推出	

Core learner takeaway

The biggest mistake with ****soft**** is translating every occurrence as:

> ****軟的****

That only works for the physical sense.

Compare:

> ****soft pillow****

> = 柔軟的枕頭

> ****soft voice****

> = 輕柔的聲音

> ****soft light****

> = 柔和的光線

> ****soft colour****

> = 柔和的顏色

> ****soft-hearted person****

> = 心軟 / 有同情心的人

> ****be soft on someone****

> = 對某人太寬鬆

> ****soft approach****

> = 溫和策略

> ****soft target****

> = 容易下手的目標

> ****soft landing****

> = 平穩著陸 / 平穩過渡

> ****soft skills****

> = 軟技能

> ****soft power****

> = 軟實力

> ****soft drink****

> = 非酒精飲品 / 汽水

> ****soft water****

> = 軟水

> ****soft market****

> = 疲弱市場

> ****soften your tone****

> = 放柔 / 緩和語氣

> ****software****

> = 軟件 / 軟體

So the broad semantic thread behind ****soft**** is:

****“not hard, harsh, forceful, sharp, or intense.”****

From physical softness, English extends the idea metaphorically to:

> sound

> light

> personality

> discipline

> communication

> economics

> business strategy

> technology

That makes ****soft**** an excellent high-value polysemy word.